MKTG3112
MARKETING COMMUNICATIONS
INDIVIDUAL ESSAY

ALO YOGA · SYDNEY

~~mat to moment~~

the keep list ✓

A critical reflection on our integrated marketing communications campaign, and an alternative approach built around what's worth keeping.

STUDENT NUMBER
560838628

WORD COUNT
1,923

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Question One – Evaluating “Mat to Moment”

1.1 Overall Assessment

Campaign effectiveness means achieving intended outcomes, not simply generating reach or likes (Belch & Belch, 2021). Against our four objectives, Mat to Moment is more likely to build store awareness (O3) than perceived worth (O1), despite our ranking O1 first (Appendix A). The objectives are a strength because they are specific, measurable and linked to identified challenges (Colley, 1961). The weakness was how consistently our execution supported them.

1.2 Target Audience

Segment A, 22–34-year-old women in Sydney who treat activewear as part of their identity, remains appropriate (Belk, 1988). However, financial pressure creates a tension our campaign did not resolve (Deloitte, 2026). At A$100–200 per item, Alo is positioned as “masstige” rather than luxury. These buyers buy more in categories they value while cutting back elsewhere (Silverstein & Fiske, 2003). We followed Kapferer and Bastien’s (2009) argument that luxury needs meaning rather than justification. I now see our audience also needs a reason to prioritise Alo, as guilt can suppress indulgent purchases unless the expense feels worthwhile (Okada, 2005).

1.3 Message Design

Our line, “From Mat to Moment”, communicates a clear lifestyle proposition, while its calm, post-class imagery contrasts with rivals’ focus on sweat, demonstrating creative divergence (Smith & Yang, 2004). However, moving from exercise to everyday wear defines athleisure (Merriam-Webster, n.d.), and our report shows that P.E Nation already promotes leggings this way (P.E Nation, n.d.). Therefore, the execution may stand out without making the proposition distinctive to Alo. Competitor attribution is a risk to our 60% brand-attribution target, although this requires testing.

Price justification is also underdeveloped. On bus panels and Instagram posts, “Worth it” is supported only by an “instructor-tested” label. Interested viewers might consider this relevant evidence, but without explaining what was tested, it may function mainly as a peripheral quality cue (Petty et al., 1983). Attitudes formed peripherally tend to be less enduring, less resistant to competing messages, and less predictive of behaviour (Petty &

Cacioppo, 1986). More complete justification appears only on product pages, in stores, and at 36 sessions reaching a few hundred people. Most viewers would therefore see only the label, so their sense that Alo is worth the price (O1) could fade or lose out to rivals before they buy.

1.4 Channel Selection

Outdoor receives A$55,000, or 22% of the budget, despite its low audience selectivity (Belch & Belch, 2021). Store-route panels can support O3, but their limited scope to explain price makes their contribution to O1 less convincing. By contrast, Instagram and TikTok allow the proposed creator videos to combine a fuller value argument with targeted exposure. Their potential ad reach equals 69.2% and 51.2% of Australian adults respectively, with women aged 25–34 representing Instagram's largest age-and-gender segment and a substantial segment on TikTok (Kemp, 2026; Sprout Social, 2026).

1.5 Integration

Integration is our plan's main strength. Every touchpoint carries the same line, set and sign-off, while hooks and calls to action vary, creating consistency without identical executions (Batra & Keller, 2016). However, our objectives assumed Vaughn's (1980) feel–learn–do order, in which people feel something about a fashion brand before weighing facts, yet our AIDA journey delays the more complete price argument until Desire in Burst 2 (Strong, 1925). Therefore, our touchpoints achieved commonality but not complementarity, because the key argument needed to support O1 appeared where only a few people were likely to see it (Keller, 2001).

1.6 Likely Effectiveness and Measurement

O3 is most likely to succeed because store locations are repeated across touchpoints, which consumers can remember without much thought (Petty et al., 1983). O2 is plausible because Sydney sources add local relevance, which builds closer consumer relationships even for global brands (Sichtmann et al., 2019). O1 remains at risk, potentially weakening O4, as visits tend to follow attitudes rather than precede them (Vaughn, 1980). Evaluation is limited. Only paid social, 21% of spend, uses randomised holdouts. The remaining activity relies on before-and-after comparisons, which can overstate advertising effects (Gordon et al., 2019).

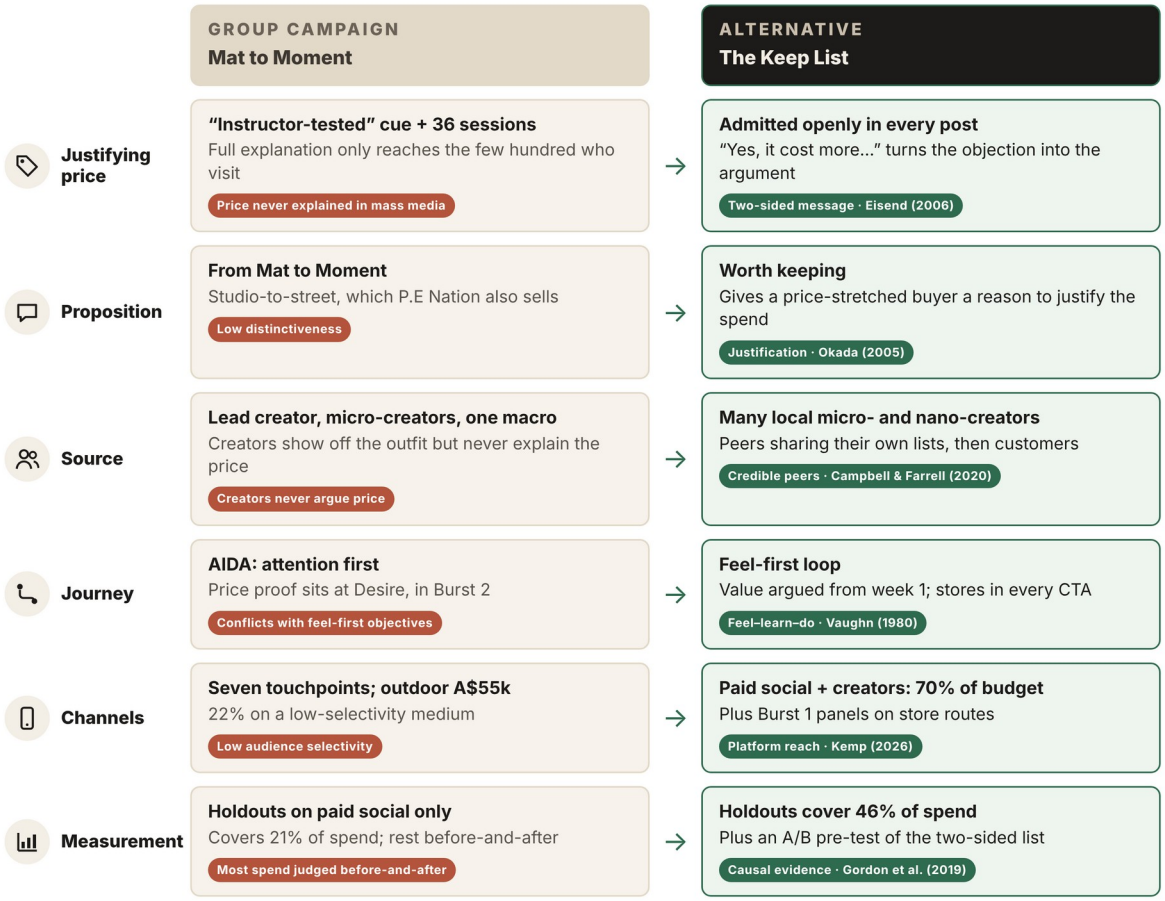
Question Two – An Alternative Approach, “The Keep List”

2.1 What I Changed and Why

The Keep List retains Segment A, objectives O1–O4, Sydney sources, and consistent brand codes, while addressing the weaknesses in Question One (Figure 1). Perceived worth remains the highest-ranked objective, but now leads the creative strategy rather than relying on explanations in lower-reach touchpoints.

Figure 1

What Changes From the Group Campaign



Note. Weaknesses come from Question One and the group report, and tags show the main source justifying each change.

2.2 Audience and Insight

I retain Segment A because its identity-driven buying fits Alo (Belk, 1988). The unresolved price tension needs a stronger value argument, not a different audience. In 2024, "loud budgeting", openly naming what you will not spend on, spread on TikTok as a statement of

choice (Axios, 2024). My insight, extending Belk's idea that possessions express the self, is that what financially pressured young women choose to keep can express their identity as clearly as what they cut. Alo's premium all-day positioning therefore stays, but is framed as "worth keeping", not the less distinctive "studio to street".

2.3 Message, Persuasion Route and Sources

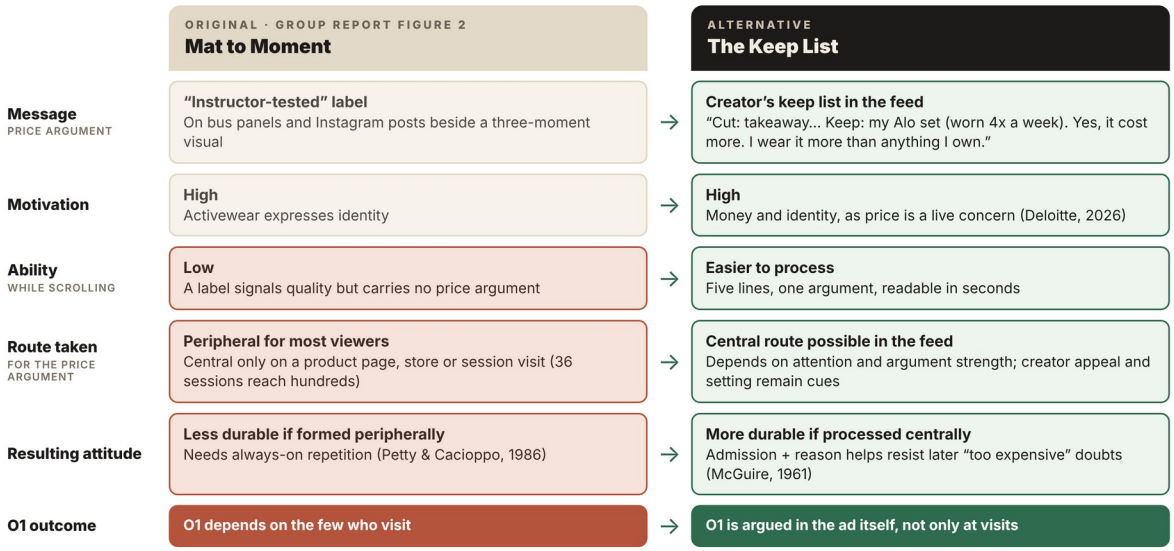
My message is two-sided, with creators acknowledging the premium before explaining why Alo is worth keeping. This admission can strengthen credibility, although Eisend's (2006) meta-analysis shows persuasion depends on how negative information is presented, not simply whether it is included. Therefore, the list keeps the admission brief and answers it immediately, as creators explain how frequent wear makes the expense worthwhile (Okada, 2005). The format also draws on mental accounting, where consumers organise spending into separate budgets (Thaler, 1999; Appendix B). Keeping Alo while cutting elsewhere moves it from a "fashion splurge" into "things I use every day", justifying the price without discounts weakening Alo's premium positioning (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009).

However, frequent wear alone could justify any activewear brand. Creators must show their own Alo set across different occasions and explain the specific reasons they keep choosing it over alternatives. This makes Alo the subject of the explanation, reducing the attribution risk raised in Question One.

Under the Elaboration Likelihood Model, careful consideration (the central route) requires motivation and ability (Petty et al., 1983). The Keep List brings the price argument into the ad, so viewers get reasons why Alo is worth the price instead of a label suggesting quality (Figure 2). Financial pressure supplies the motivation, because price already matters to this audience, while the short list provides the ability, as its reasoning can be followed in seconds. This creates an opportunity for central processing, not a guarantee, as feed distraction and argument strength still matter. Still, the case for O1 now reaches viewers at first exposure, not only the few hundred who visit.

Figure 2

Elaboration Likelihood Model, Before and After



Note. Adapted from Petty et al. (1983) and the group report's Figure 2.

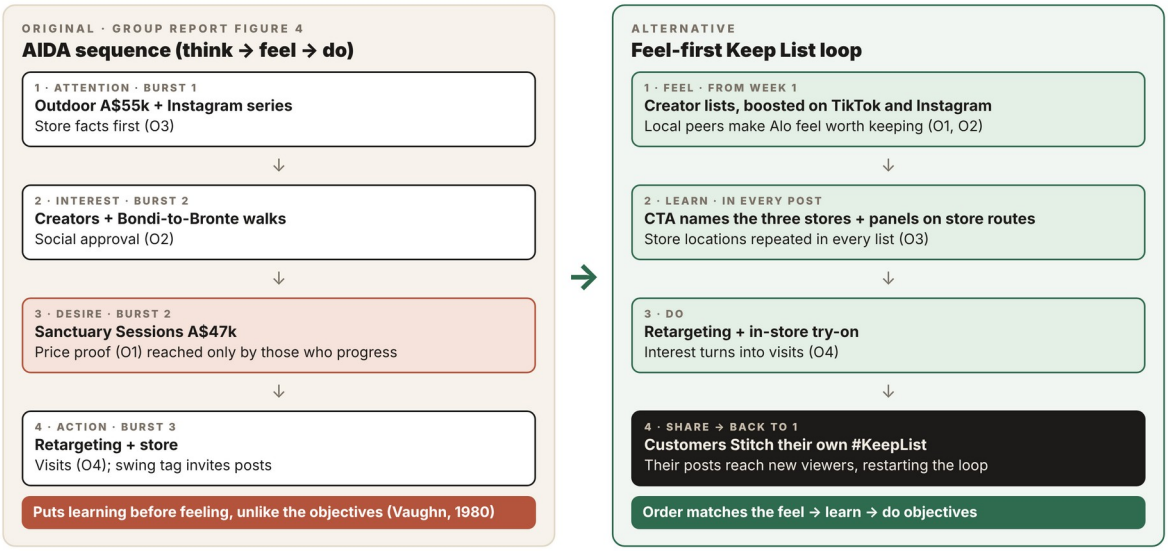
Sydney micro- and nano-creators introduce the format, with customers then invited to share their own lists. Unlike our original creators, all argue price, and micro-creators' closeness to their followers can make an honest price admission more credible (Campbell & Farrell, 2020). The repeated format, wordmark and sign-off act as distinctive assets, helping viewers attribute each story to Alo (Sharp, 2010).

2.4 Journey

Figure 3 replaces our AIDA journey with Vaughn's (1980) feel–learn–do model, the order our objectives already assumed, with bursts reordered to match (Appendix C). I use it as a planning guide, not a fixed path every viewer follows. Each list makes Alo feel worth keeping through local peers (feel, O1, O2), then names the stores (learn, O3). Retargeting and in-store try-ons turn that interest into visits (do, O4). Customers' Stitched replies on TikTok can become another viewer's first exposure, linking advocacy back to discovery (Court et al., 2009).

Figure 3

Consumer Journey, Before and After



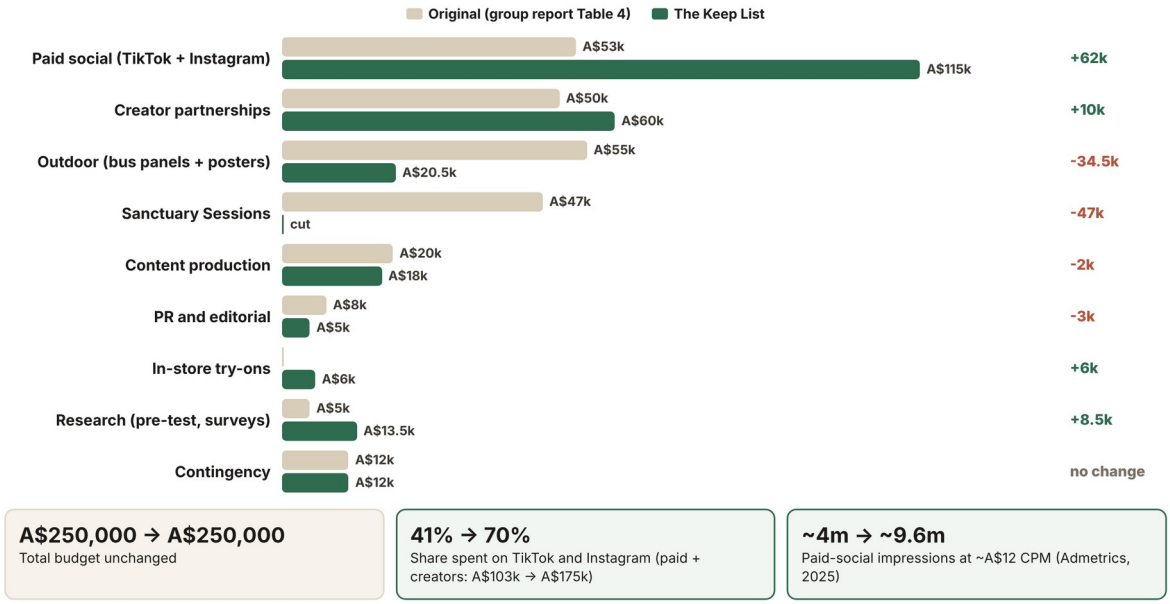
Note. Adapted from Strong (1925), Vaughn (1980), Court et al. (2009) and the group report's Figure 4.

2.5 Channels and Budget

Within A$250,000 (Figure 4), I remove Sanctuary Sessions (A$47,000), which reached only a few hundred people, and reduce outdoor from A$55,000 to A$20,500, retaining Burst 1 panels on store routes because they still support O3. Paid social and creator partnerships rise from A$103,000 to A$175,000, or 70% of the budget, because these channels carry the value argument rather than only the store message. At an assumed A$12 per thousand impressions (Admetrics, 2025), A$115,000 in paid social could generate 9.6 million impressions, against the original four million forecast. This is a planning scenario, not proof of effectiveness.

Figure 4

Budget Reallocation Within A$250,000



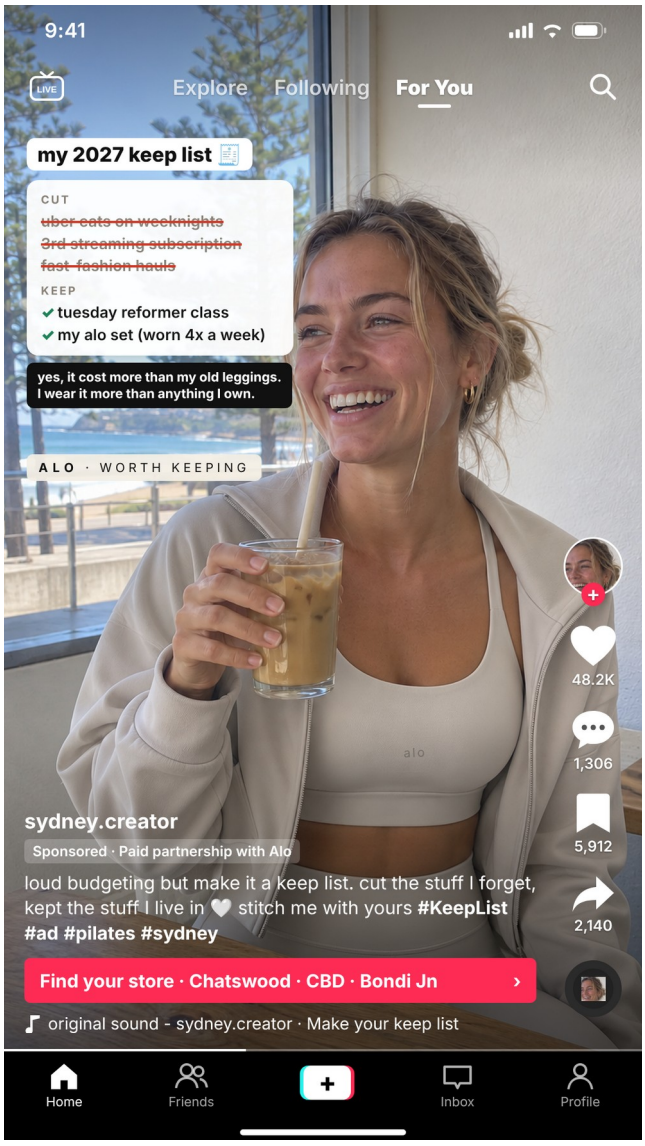
Note. Original figures are from the group report's Table 4. Bus panels cover 20 panels for three weeks at GoTransit (n.d.) rates plus production, with A$4,000 for posters. Creators cover about 100 micro and nano posts at A$150–750 each (Wise, 2025).

To test this, a pre-test would compare one-sided and two-sided messages on perceived worth and brand attribution (Belch & Belch, 2021). Randomised holdouts would assess paid-social effects on perceived worth and store-visit intention, covering 46% of spend rather than 21% (Gordon et al., 2019; Appendix D). Store-locator clicks and visit data would add indicators of actual visits, though not causal ones.

2.6 Creative Mock-up

Figure 5

"The Keep List" TikTok In-Feed Creator Post (Burst 1)



Note. The photograph is AI-generated and placed into a mock TikTok frame. The person is not real, and the handle and engagement numbers are made up for illustration. Prompts used (abridged):

(1) Photograph, made with ChatGPT: "Photorealistic vertical phone photo that looks like a still from a TikTok video, not a professional shoot. A woman in her mid-twenties sits by the window of a Bondi café around 9am, just after a reformer Pilates class. She wears a matching Alo-style set in a soft neutral 'bone' colour, a sports bra, high-waisted leggings and a cropped zip jacket, with no text or logos. Natural, unretouched skin, messy low bun, laughing while holding an iced oat latte. Soft morning light, with the ocean and Norfolk pines blurred behind her. She sits in the right half of the frame, leaving space top-left and at the bottom for text."

(2) TikTok frame, made with Claude (Anthropic): "Place this photo in an accurate TikTok For You Spark Ad frame with the usual tabs, side icons, 'Paid partnership with Alo' label, a caption with #KeepList and #ad, and a 'Find your store' button listing Chatswood, CBD and Bondi Junction. Add TikTok-style text overlays: 'my 2027 keep list', a Notes-style list with crossed-out items (Uber Eats on weeknights, a third streaming subscription, fast-fashion hauls) and kept items (Tuesday reformer class, my Alo set, worn 4x a week), the line 'yes, it cost more than my old leggings. I wear it more than anything I own.', an 'ALO · WORTH KEEPING' sticker and a small 'alo' wordmark on the sports bra. Keep text clear of her face."

Media format. Figure 5 shows a 15-second TikTok Spark Ad. The list appears line by line alongside the creator's voice-over, moving from the price admission to her reasons for keeping the set, before introducing Alo. Promoting the creator's original post keeps her username and comments visible (TikTok for Business, n.d.-a), so viewers can see who is explaining the choice.

Message. The lowercase headline "my 2027 keep list" feels like a personal note and introduces the idea within three seconds, following TikTok's guidance on presenting the main proposition early (TikTok for Business, n.d.-b). The price admission acknowledges the objection rather than avoiding it, while "worn 4x a week" gives the creator a clear starting point for explaining the set's value (Okada, 2005). "Alo. Worth keeping." then connects that explanation to the brand.

Imagery. The creator wears the matching set in a beachside Sydney café after class, showing how it fits into everyday life beyond exercise. The setting adds local relevance (O2), but one café scene cannot demonstrate frequent use. Brief clips of the same set throughout her week would make "worn 4x a week" more convincing. Natural light and handheld footage would help the video feel like an everyday creator post instead of a perfected brand shoot. Actual posts would feature creators with different body types and avoid retouching, given concerns that fitness imagery on Instagram can increase appearance pressure among young women (Camacho-Miñano et al., 2019).

Design. TikTok's built-in text style makes the list feel familiar, while red strikethroughs and green ticks help viewers follow each choice as it appears. Alo's neutral colours and wordmark keep the brand recognisable (Sharp, 2010) and maintain its premium, minimal look, not resembling a discount promotion. "Paid partnership" and #ad keep its commercial purpose clear, even though the post feels personal (Australian Association of National Advertisers [AANA], 2021; Wojdynski & Evans, 2016).

Call to action. "Find your store" names Chatswood, the CBD and Bondi Junction, giving viewers a practical next step (O3, O4). The ad directs them to stores instead of online checkout because O4 measures visits.

AI limitations. The AI-generated photograph looks too polished for the intended phone-footage style. It also reproduces Alo's clothes and logo inaccurately, while one slim model

cannot represent the different bodies within Segment A. The mock-up therefore communicates the concept more clearly than it demonstrates the intended realism or inclusivity. Actual posts would need real creators wearing Alo and giving honest accounts of their use and spending choices, instead of presenting scripted claims as personal experience (Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cth) sch 2 s 18).

2.7 Advantages, Limitations and Expected Effectiveness

The main risk is how the message comes across. Cutting other spending to justify premium leggings could seem out of touch, especially alongside café and Pilates imagery. Creators must explain their own choices without suggesting viewers should sacrifice necessities for Alo (Sher, 2011). Removing sessions reduces hands-on proof. I expect stronger support for O1 and O2, while O3 remains supported. O4 depends on whether credible, Alo-specific explanations give prospective buyers a reason to visit, not just on more impressions.

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AI Disclosure

AI was used to assist with background research, figure/table/appendices/cover formatting, references, evaluating report vs rubric to highlight areas for improvement and to cut down words. All ideas are my own and this report was written by me.

Appendix A

Figure A1

Evaluation of "Mat to Moment" Against Its Objectives

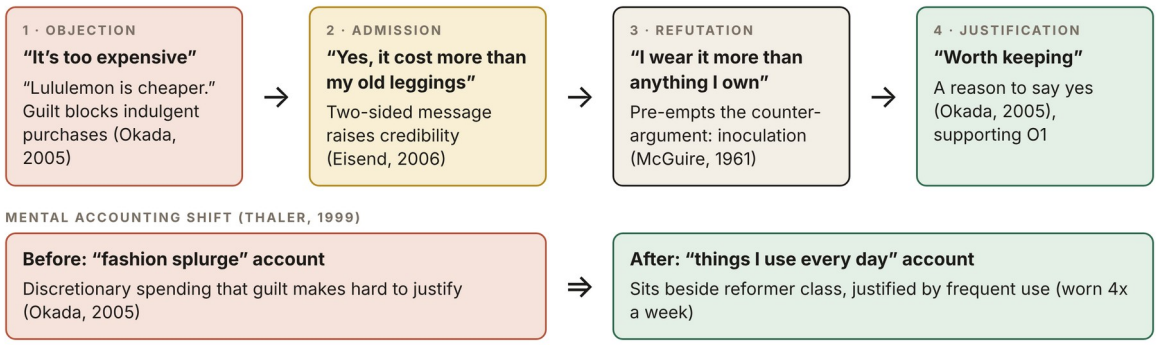
Objective	Main mechanism in the group plan	Evaluation	Likely outcome
O3 Learn: aware of Sydney stores (25% → 35%)	Store names on outdoor (A$55k) and the Instagram series in Burst 1	A simple fact suits peripheral learning (Petty et al., 1983); repetition builds memory (Keller, 2001)	Likely Strongest objective
O2 Feel: "a brand for people like me in Sydney" (12% → 18%)	Sydney instructors, creators and settings re-encode the LA brand	Localness adds relational value, even for global brands (Sichtmann et al., 2019)	Possible
O1 Feel: "worth paying more for" (15% → 21%)	"Instructor-tested" cue on reach media; proof in sessions, product pages and stores	Cue never explains price; central route reaches self-selected visitors only (Petty & Cacioppo, 1986); guilt unaddressed (Okada, 2005)	At risk Top priority, weakest mechanism
O4 Do: visited store or site (8% → 11%)	Retargeting, session bookings, store CTAs	Behaviour follows attitude (Vaughn, 1980), so depends on O1	Uncertain

Note. My evaluation, supporting Question One.

Appendix B

Figure B1

Two-Sided Message Structure, Inoculation and Mental Accounting

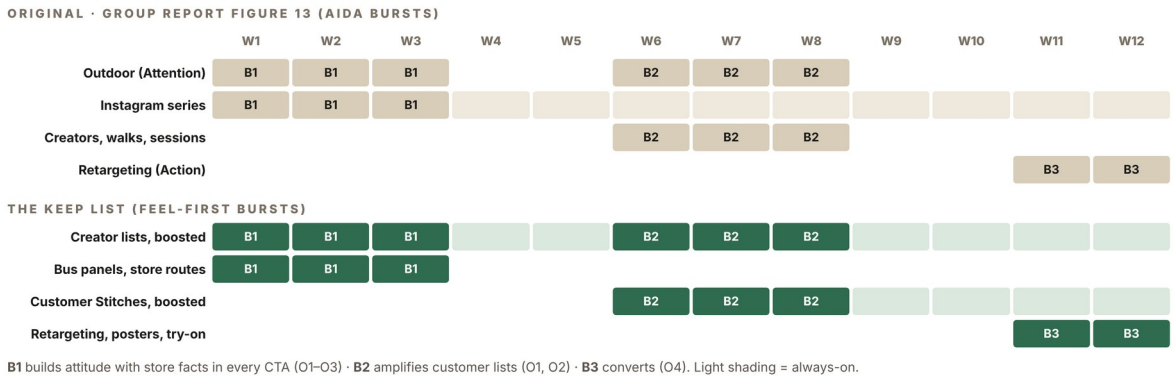


Note. Adapted from Eisend (2006), McGuire (1961), Okada (2005) and Thaler (1999).

Appendix C

Figure C1

Pulsing Schedule, Before and After

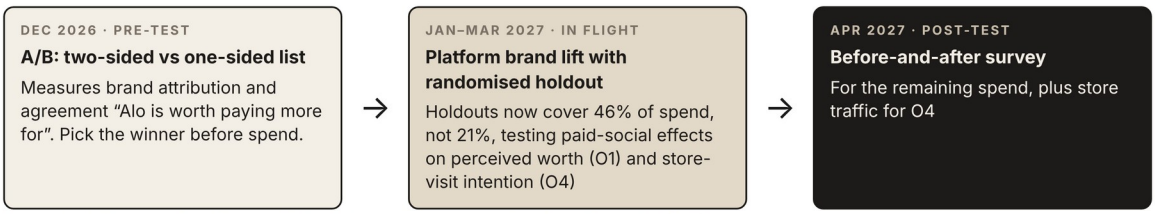


Note. Adapted from the group report's Figure 13, with pulsing from Belch and Belch (2021).

Appendix D

Figure D1

Pre-Testing, In-Flight and Post-Testing Plan



Pre- and post-testing stages from Belch and Belch (2021); randomised holdout rationale from Gordon et al. (2019).

Note. Adapted from Belch and Belch (2021) and Gordon et al. (2019).